

Generating APIs Using Django Rest Framework with Insomnia

This article gives the fundamentals of generating APIs using Django Rest Framework with Insomnia. It's aimed at absolute beginners.



This article will familiarise you with the basic structural layout and features that come with creating a Django project for API generation. It will help you understand what models, serializers and views are, how they are interconnected, and how we can use Insomnia to test the functioning of CRUD (create, read, update and delete) operations on our APIs.

Initial setup

You will be required to use the command prompt or carry out the initial steps needed to create a Django project. Check the version of Python you have installed on your system:

```
python --version
```

Pip can be defined as an installation manager for packages/libraries that are written in Python. Let's download a file called *get-pip.py*:

```
curl https://bootstrap.pypa.io/get-pip.py -o get-pip.py
```

To install pip, give the following command:

```
python get-pip.py
```

Note: Figure 1 shows pip as being uninstalled first and then reinstalled, because I already had pip installed on my system.

Now let us understand what 'virtual environments' are before we create a

Django project. To state bluntly, virtual environments are environments that can have distinct versions of packages/libraries installed within them, respectively. Let me explain that with an example. We are in April 2022, and we intend to create a project (to be dealt with in VS Code). Let's say the latest version of Python is 3.1 (which we have installed in our system and no virtual environments have been created) having libraries a, b, c, d, e and f. Assume that our project requires libraries a, b and c, all of which are in Python 3.1; hence our project will work without any hindrances.

Now let's say Python's new version 3.2 comes out a few weeks or a few months later which has libraries a, d, e, f, g and h. We install this new